B Major

Scale Practice Worksheet · 5 sharps (C♯, D♯, F♯, G♯, A♯) · 4 octaves

SCALES

01 Scale — Parallel Motion

Play B major up and down in parallel motion.

> **TIP**
> B major is particularly comfortable — this key is paradise compared to C♯ minor. To improve quality, practice with rhythmic variations: accent every second note.

02 Scale in Thirds

Play the B major scale in thirds — two notes a third apart, played together or in succession.

> **TIP**
> RH starts on finger 3. LH starts on finger 4.

ARPEGGIOS & CHORDS — TONIC

03 Short Arpeggios

Play short arpeggios of the tonic triad — three notes only, without adding the octave. Don't use the 5th finger. **B – D♯ – F♯**, then **D♯ – F♯ – B**, then **F♯ – B – D♯**. This small version appears in pieces more often than the full four-note chord. Practice playing it fast.

04 Eleven Long Chords

Play extended arpeggios through a cycle of eleven chords in sequence. Play each chord as a long arpeggio across the keyboard, then move immediately to the next without stopping.

The eleven-chord cycle for B major:

Tonic:

1) **B major** — root position

2) **B minor** — root position

3) **G major** — 1st inversion

4) **G♯ minor** — 1st inversion

5) **E major** — 2nd inversion

6) **E minor** — 2nd inversion

Dominant:

7) **B7** — root position

8) **G7** — 1st inversion

9) **E7** — 2nd inversion

10) **C♯7** — 3rd inversion

Diminished:

11) **Dim** — 4-note chord (vii°) B–D–F–A♭–B

> TIP
> Playing all eleven in a row builds stamina — very rarely do you get such sustained intensity. If accuracy drops, slow down. The broken arpeggio form can also be applied to the same sequence.

05 Dominant Arpeggios

Play arpeggios of the F♯7 chord — a five-finger chord that includes the octave. Play through all inversions.

1) Root position: **F♯ – A♯ – C♯ – E – F♯**

2) 1st inversion: **A♯ – C♯ – E – F♯ – A♯**

3) 2nd inversion: **C♯ – E – F♯ – A♯ – C♯**

4) 3rd inversion: **E – F♯ – A♯ – C♯ – E**

TIP

The dominant chord causes the most wrong notes — the intervals are all different distances (major third, minor third, minor third, major second). Practice remembering the distances. Find pairs of notes that feel uncomfortable and isolate them.

06 Double Thirds

Play B major in double thirds. The most important thing is knowing where your fingers go — specifically where the 5th finger lands.

5th finger anchor points:

RH — 5th finger on `F#` and `C#`

LH — 5th finger on `A#` (used only once)

2nd finger anchor point:

RH — 2nd finger on `G#`

Complete fingering, ascending from B (bottom note / top note):

RH:

B–D#: `1/3` C#–E: `2/4` D#–F#: `3/5` E–G#: `1/3`

F#–A#: `1/4` G#–B: `2/4` A#–C#: `3/5`

LH:

B–D#: `4/2` C#–E: `3/1` D#–F#: `4/2` E–G#: `3/1`

F#–A#: `4/2` G#–B: `3/1` A#–C#: `5/2`

Practice separate hands first. Connect each pair of thirds as legato as possible. Then combine both hands very slowly.

> TIP
> In double thirds, everything is about how legato you can play — how well you connect each third. This is why fingering is so important.

VARIATIONS

Contrary Motion

Any scale or arpeggio exercise can be played in contrary motion — one hand ascending while the other descends simultaneously. This is harder than parallel motion and excellent brain training.

Accent & Rhythmic Variations

Apply to any scale or arpeggio exercise for fluidity and evenness:

a Accent every note — extra weight on each individual note.

b Accent every second note — grouped, rolling feel.

c Triplet groupings — organize the scale in groups of three.

d Groups of four — organize the scale in groups of four.

e Prolong one note per group — hold the 2nd or 3rd note slightly longer to build control.

Staccato

Any scale exercise can be played staccato — lift from each key rather than connecting the notes. Treat it as a separate pass, not a replacement for legato practice.

GENERAL PRACTICE PRINCIPLES

- Choose a slow tempo to start — tensing your hands defeats the purpose of the exercise
- Stamina comes from sustained intensity — playing eleven chords in a row with no breaks is the point, not individual perfection
- In double thirds, legato quality depends entirely on fingering
- When you lose accuracy, slow down immediately — don't push through mistakes hoping they fix themselves
- Every hand is different — what is uncomfortable for one person may be easy for another, so don't stress
- When practicing one hand alone, raise the other hand above your head — the non-playing hand sleeps and does nothing